The Developmental Wheel

Children move through repeating phases. A calm, settled phase is followed by an unsettled one, and each unsettled phase leads to new growth.

Calm and settled (equilibrium) · Unsettled (disequilibrium)

In the first year the same phases come every few weeks. The research observed mostly white, middle-class American children from the 1930s to the 1970s, so timing varies across children and cultures.

Adapted from Gesell, Ilg and Ames, The Child from Five to Ten (1977), and Ilg and Ames, Child Behavior (1955), Gesell Institute of Human Development.